A-A-1446B
May 1, 1983
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1446A
March 14, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPE, MAILING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification UU-E-522.

Salient characteristics:

Construction. Envelopes shall be high-cut diagonal, web-fed point flap side seam or center seam construction. Envelopes shall be sufficiently high cut so as to prevent the flap adhesive from contacting the envelope contents. The sealed seams shall not adhere to the inside of the envelope. Envelopes shall be free from cuts, folds, tears, machine marks, foreign matter, dirt, ink smears and adhesive stains.

When ordered for use in specific automatic inserting and sealing machines, the envelopes shall meet the design and construction requirements specified by the equipment manufacturer.

Flap adhesive. All sealing flap adhesive shall be the water-activated type of such a consistency to prevent premature sealing of the flap and curling of the envelope after drying. The flap adhesive shall be uniformly applied and have a minimum thickness of 0.0006 inch. The flaps shall be capable of being quickly and securely sealed using reasonable pressure after moistening the adhesive. When opened 15 to 20 seconds after sealing, the flap shall pull fibers from the body of the envelope from not less than 75% of the adhesive area.

Split gumming is permitted on high-cut diagonal seams but shall be positioned over the seams and not exceed seam width.

When specified, resin gum (temperature and humidity resistant) shall be supplied on the sealing flap. Resin gummed envelopes may have split gumming on the sealing flap. On resin gummed envelopes without split gumming, there shall be no contact between the sealing flap and the diagonal seams except at the very tip of the flap. Envelopes with resin gum shall be able to withstand test storage conditions of $100^{0} \pm 2^{0}$ F and 80 ± 2 percent relative humidity for 24 hours without blocking.

All adhesive shall be clean and free from offensive odor and ingredients that would discolor the paper.

Windows. Windows, when ordered, shall have rounded or slightly rounded corners shall be the size and location specified and shall comply with all applicable U.S. Postal Service regulations. The window shall be covered on the inside with a transparent polystyrene window material glued securely on all edges so as not to interfere with insertion or contents. The transparent polystyrene window material shall be free of any condition which would prevent the address from being distinctly legible.

Printing. Printing shall be as specified and shall comply with all applicable U.S. Postal Service and National Archives and Record Service regulations. The envelopes shall accept printing and ink writing without feathering, smearing, or penetrating to the reverse side.

Physical properties. Envelopes shall be supplied in one of four styles as stated below. Natural kraft envelopes shall be made from commercial envelope grade natural kraft.

Styles A and B requirements.

Style A - Light brown shade, 100 percent sulfate pulp.
Style B - Natural kraft, 100 percent sulfate pulp.

						TAPPI #
Basis wt. (17 x 22-500), ± 5 percent: pounds	20	24	28	32	40	T-410
Bursting strength, min. : lbs/in^2	30	38	44	50	60	T-403
Thickness, SUB 20 only : inch	0.0040 - 0.0051					T-411
Smoothness, Sheffield, Style B only: average	65 min./275 max.					T-518

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Styles C and D requirements.

Style C - White, 95 percent bleached chemical pulp; bleached, and/or groundwood not to exceed 5 percent.
Style D - Colored, 100 percent bleached chemical pulp; pulp dyed to color specified. Colors include goldenrod, blue, green or pink.

When ordering, purchaser should specify Style; when Style D is ordered, purchaser should specify color(s).

			TAPPI #
Basis wt (17 x 22-500), ± 5 percent: pounds	20	24	T-410
Bursting strength, min. : lbs/in^2	20	24	T-403
Opacity, average, min. : percent	86	89	UM-411
No individual opacity measurement less than:%	84	87	

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Preservation, packing, packing, labeling and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract ot order.

Notes: 1. NARS regulations are available from the Archivist of the United States, National Archives and Record Services, 8th Street and Pennsylvania Ave., N.W., Washington, DC 20408.

2. Postal regulations are available from the United States Postal Service, Rates and Classification Department, 475 L'Enfant Plaza, S.W., Washington, DC 20260.

3. TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, Technical Park/Atlanta, Atlanta, GA 30341.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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